Herzog’s compromise proposal doesn’t seem to get anywhere; many consider it insufficiently clear. In any case, Netanyahu did not answer; Levin and Rotman are determined to push ahead.

The pilots who were supposed to stay away from reserve duty tomorrow will report to their base, but instead of flying they will hold a conversation with their crews about the political situation. They call the debate a “fighters’ conversation” (*siah lohamim*), the name given to a famous soldiers’ conversation on the morrow of the Six-Day War; it was organized by Amos Oz, among others, (translated into English under the title “The Seventh Day”) and it expressed, already in 1967, some of the same doubts surfacing now and comparing the suffering of the Arabs forced to flee to the fate of Jews fleeing not so long before. It was impressive, given the overall atmosphere of quasi-hysterical nationalist jubilation engulfing Israel in those postwar days.

I quoted extensively from the “fighters’ conversation” in a book I published in French in 1969 under the title *Reflexions sur l’avenir d’Israel* (Reflections on the future of Israel) in which I foresaw, if I may say, that a prolonged occupation of Palestinian conquered territories would destroy the values that Israel was supposedly built upon. I do not feel proud about my foresight of what the occupation would do to Israel, for the simple reason that I did not think, at the time, of what it would do to the Palestinians … It took me two to three more years to understand that.

The organizers of the demonstrations have announced a huge “protest against dictatorship day” for Thursday. Even if only part of the program they are planning gets accomplished, it will be quite impressive. The demonstrations seem to be growing in scale and impact.

In one of the dispatches from the Holy Land, I read that some interviewees envisaged a return to the biblical situation whereby the Kingdom of David and Solomon split into two separate kingdoms: Judea and Samaria. One state that would be more traditionalist, more religious,